KEY INDICES

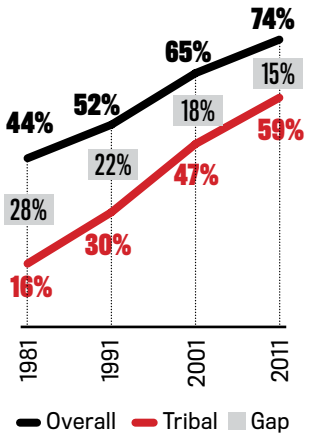
THE LEARNING CURVE

Tribals are yet to catch up with the rest of the population in accessing quality education



LITERACY RATE

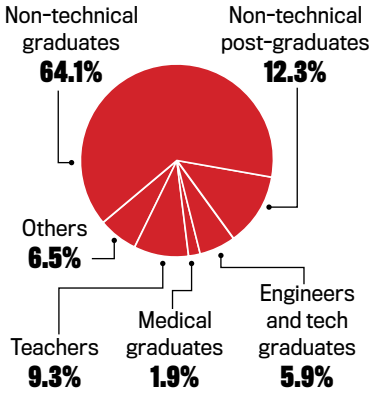
As per Census



Source: Census reports

LEVEL OF HIGHER EDUCATION

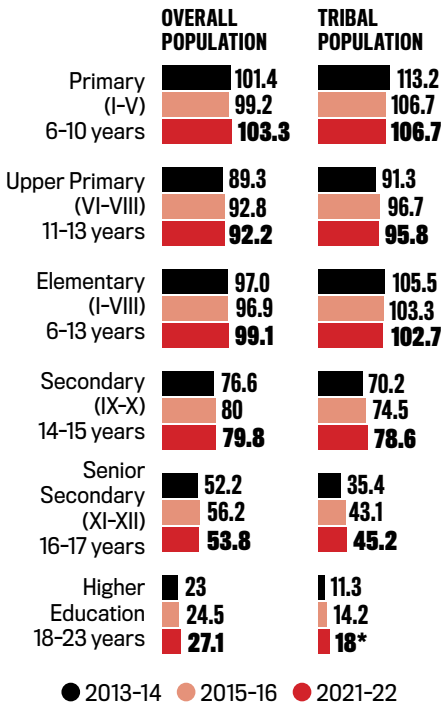
Of the graduates among tribals, a majority were non-technical ones



Source: Annual Report, Ministry of Tribal Affairs, 2021-22

GROSS ENROLMENT RATIO FOR TRIBAL STUDENTS

The GER of tribals in primary education is higher than national average but not so in higher education



Source: Unified District Information System for Education Plus 2020-21, All India Survey on Higher Education Report, 2019-20
**for 2019-20, all figures in per cent*

scheme allocation every year as tribal sub plan or scheduled tribe component funds. These allocations rose by 50 per cent between 2017-18 and 2020-21: from Rs 22,906.54 crore to Rs 34,492.87. The ministry of tribal affairs provides additional funds to these initiatives to plug the gaps. Its budget shot up by 53 per cent from Rs 5,494.51 crore in 2020-21 to Rs 8,451.92 crore this fiscal. Besides these, the Pradhan Mantri Adi Adarsh Gram Yojna (PMAAGY) aims to provide basic infrastructure in 36,428 villages with significant tribal population. And the Pradhan Mantri Janjatiya Vikas Mission (PMJVM), with a total outlay of Rs 1,612.27 crore for five years (2021-26), is designed to facilitate tribal entrepreneurship initiatives and livelihood opportunities.

Despite all this, socio-economic indicators suggest tribals are among the poorest and most marginalised sections of India. Some 90 per cent live in rural areas, according to the 2011 Census—which is natural, given their old life patterns. But in terms of poverty, there is huge disparity between tribals and the rest—45 per cent of rural tribals were in the BPL category in 2011-12 as against 26 per cent of all rural Indians. Their literacy rate in 2011 was just 59 per cent, compared to 74 per cent for India. On almost all health indicators, such as infant mortality rate, underweight children and anaemia in women, tribals have fared much worse than the rest. This stark contrast further alienates many tribals, with human development nowhere commensurate with the official spend. A focused, inclusive approach is clearly imperative. With a tribal now as the first citizen, this could be the beginning of a new era. ■

ON ALMOST ALL HEALTH INDICATORS, TRIBALS HAVE FARED MUCH WORSE THAN THE GENERAL POPULATION